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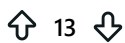
**r/virtualization** • 3y ago
BlaringSiren

Lightweight hypervisor OS?

I'm planning to turn my workstation into a hypervisor and looking for a lightweight OS that isn't ram intensive.

I thought OpenBSD would be perfect for this but the native hypervisor, vmm doesn't support graphics. Would FreeBSD with bhyve be the next best option? Maybe minimal Debian or Arch?

Anyone who was in a similar situation have any advice? Thanks



13



15



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**ex800** • 3y ago

when you convert your workstation into a hypervisor, what will you use as your workstation?



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**DryPhilosopher8168** • 3y ago

Proxmox: lightweight, battle proven and can run any WM supported by Debian

qubes-os: secure xen vms with great little tricks to work together

arch: great for personal use and experimental hardware

any distro with libvirt: in the end that is all you need



12



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**NomadCF** • 3y ago

+1 for proxmox, but I would **add installing a minimalist xfce4 and firefox-esr to it**. This helps with the learning curve in the beginning as you can locally access the web interface without needing a second device or needing to recall every proxmox cli command :)



2



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**BlaringSiren** OP • 3y ago

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**DryPhilosopher8168** • 3y ago

It really depends. I would consider that proxmox has a lesser footprint then a desktop environment. It comes with ALOT of goodies that will help you to manage your vms. If you are confident with libvirt on the command line you won't need proxmox.

3 Reply ...

**belinadoseujorge** • 3y ago

take a look at xcp-ng

2 Reply ...

**kabanossi** • 3y ago

Ubuntu or Debian with KVM/libvirt or Proxmox. Either solution utilizes less than 1GB while running the KVM hypervisor.

2 Reply ...

**old-mike** • 3y ago

Nobody says LXD? It surprises me. You can have LXC containers and VMs based in QEMU. I'm using Arch + LXQt as a desktop and LXD to control my containers and VMs from the command line. Easy and light.

2 Reply ...

**GrabbenD** • 3y ago

Do you use a Arch image inside the LXD?

1 Reply ...

**old-mike** • 3y ago

Indeed, my host is Manjaro and I have two Archlinux VMs too.

And, they are now developing a WebUI! <https://discuss.linuxcontainers.org/t/a-graphical-user-interface-for-lxd/17095>

**Drwankingstein** • 3y ago

I personally use arch and ssh to manage all of my VMs, but libvirt works. if you wanted BSD, iirc one of the BSDs should work with qemu via I think it was xen? it's been a long time since I looked into it



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Are you still planning on using it as a workstation?



bloodguard • 3y ago

Maybe minimal Debian or Arch?

I'm thinking about building gaming/streaming [SFFPC](#) rig for my living room tv and was thinking about using SteamOS as the base and installing Proxmox. Given that SteamOS is built on Debian 8 installing proxmox on it may make a neat build.



Candy_Badger • 3y ago

I use plain Debian with qemu+kvm it works great. You can also look at xcp-ng and Proxmox.